The gift of life

☞ **1** Read the passage carefully and insert the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u).

M__ny Australians s__ffer from a seri__us disease that could be relieved by a tr__nspl__nt. Some people choose to d__n__t__ their organs after they die so that they can be used for tr__nspl__nts. P__ __pl__ who want to donate their __rg__ns can join the A__stralian Organ Donor R__g__st__r. If a p__rs__n is in an __cc__d__nt, their n__xt of kin may have to d__c__d__ whether to donate that person's org__ns or not. J__ __n__ng the Register makes a person's w__sh__s clear.

Organs fr__m one person could save many l__v__s. Organs that can be d__n__t__d include the h__ __rt, lung, p__ncr__ __s, kidney and liver. Tiss__es such as corneas, skin, heart v__lv__s and pericardium can also be d__n__t__d.

2 Choose the correct word from each pair in brackets.

One tissue – blood – is [wasted/donated] and used in thousands of litres every day. The blood donor's [body/family] quickly makes new blood to replace the donation. The blood can be used to help many people, such as cancer patients, accident victims and people having surgery.

Most other organs and tissues are only available from people who have [died/spare ones]. However, a living person can donate bone marrow, a kidney or a part of a liver or pancreas.

There are national registers of [patients/hospitals] who are waiting for [transplants/transport]. Organ recipients are chosen from the national registers according to [tissue/napkin] matching, their size compatibility, how long they've been waiting, their medical condition at the time, urgency, and whether the organ can be supplied to them in time. They are tested for [compatibility/intelligence] with the new organs to avoid rejection – the [biggest/least] possible problem. Once the new organs are transplanted, the patients are [sprayed/treated] with anti-rejection medicine for the rest of their lives. Only those who receive a donation from their [identical twin/friend] would not need the anti-rejection medicine.

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